The Pilgrim Fathers

1620 saw the establishment of an additional colony by the English people. These settlers had escaped religious persecution in England because they opposed what the Church of England was teaching. They wished to settle in a place where they could practice their own religious beliefs and are known today as the Pilgrim Fathers. They embarked on their journey across the Atlantic Ocean on the *Mayflower* and eventually set foot in North America in December 1620. Around 50% of those who arrived died within a year and those who survived learned from the natives. They learned to grow crops in a land that was not so similar to England. In 1628, another settlement was created in Salem.

In 1649, the Massachusetts Bay Company was founded and the following years saw the arrival of more Europeans who increased the population significantly. Many other new towns were being created at this time. Wethersfield town was established in 1634 in Connecticut. Two years later, a band of settlers abandoned Massachusetts Bay and established the town of Providence on Rhode Island.

Most of the states in the south had an agricultural economy. However, the New England colonies were based on commerce and depended heavily on the fishing industry. The settlers traded fish, timber and furs to further grow the economy.

The Europeans and Natives found themselves in bloody conflicts with each other as the European population grew. The Pequot tribe was wiped out during the Pequot War between 1634 and 1638. King Philip’s War broke out in 1675 between the natives and the settlers. King Philip was really a Native American named Metacom. The war came to an end in 1678 after Metacom was killed while running away from the English. A final treaty known as the Treaty of Casco Bay was signed by the natives to prevent another war. Both sides suffered great losses but in the end the natives were far outnumbered by the Europeans.